Scale Exercises - Section III, Level 26

Natural Minor Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two-Octave Six-String Neck Ladder

Four forward; roll back two.

Carry the Level 25 overlap through positions 1-15, all six strings, and every natural-minor key.

1. Preserve the overlap

Keep the same four-note sequence from Level 25. The formula does not change when the line reaches a new string or octave.

2. Rebuild the upper frame

Release for the G-string backreach, rebuild for the B-string offset, and treat the single high-e root as part of the pulse.

3. Shift after 96 notes

Complete all 24 groups, return to the low root, release pressure, and move the complete hand-and-thumb frame one fret.

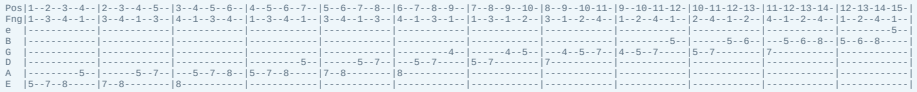
Worked example - A natural minor at low-E fret 5

Positions 1-15: A B C D E F G A B C D E F G A. Repeat the high root at the turn.

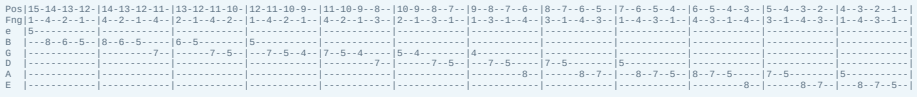
UP: 1-2-b3-4 | 2-b3-4-5 | ... | 11-12-b13-b14 | 12-b13-b14-15

DOWN: 15-b14-b13-12 | b14-b13-12-11 | ... | 5-4-b3-2 | 4-b3-2-1

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



KEY ROUTE A -> Bb -> B -> C -> C# -> D -> Eb -> E -> F -> F# -> G -> G# -> A, then reverse.

CROSSINGS UP EEEA | EEAA | EAAA | AAAD | AADD | ADDG | DDGG | DGGG | GGGB | GGBB | GBBB | BBBe

DOWN eBBB | BBBG | BBGG | BGGG | GGGD | GGDD | GDDA | DDAA | DAAA | AAAE | AAEE | AEEE

Session protocol

1. Master the 12 ascending A-minor groups.
2. Master the 12 descending A-minor groups.
3. Link the 96-note cell through both high roots.
4. Start 15-20 BPM below your clean Level 25 tempo.
5. Use 2-3 neighboring rungs with both pick starts.
6. Remove the pause and reverse after fret 17.

Level 26 - Chromatic Natural-Minor Route and Sequence Map

Up: complete one 96-note cell, then move +1 fret

Down: reverse the cards, then move -1 fret

Rung	Key	Low-E root	Frame	Scale tones (degrees 1-b7)
01	A natural minor	fret 5	4-8	A B C D E F G
02	Bb natural minor	fret 6	5-9	Bb C Db Eb F Gb Ab
03	B natural minor	fret 7	6-10	B C# D E F# G A
04	C natural minor	fret 8	7-11	C D Eb F G Ab Bb
05	C# natural minor	fret 9	8-12	C# D# E F# G# A B
06	D natural minor	fret 10	9-13	D E F G A Bb C
07	Eb natural minor	fret 11	10-14	Eb F Gb Ab Bb Cb Db
08	E natural minor	fret 12	11-15	E F# G A B C D
09	F natural minor	fret 13	12-16	F G Ab Bb C Db Eb
10	F# natural minor	fret 14	13-17	F# G# A B C# D E
11	G natural minor	fret 15	14-18	G A Bb C D Eb F
12	G# natural minor	fret 16	15-19	G# A# B C# D# E F#
13	A natural minor (octave)	fret 17	16-20	A B C D E F G

How to use

Up pass:
rungs 01-13.

Turn:
complete the fret-17 cell, then reverse.

Down pass:
rungs 12-01; do not replay rung 13.

Pulse:
one four-note group per beat as sixteenths.

Hands:
rebuild at the G backreach and B-string offset.

Goal:
make 24 groups sound like one connected line.

Sequence and crossing anatomy

```
UP:    1-2-b3-4 | 2-b3-4-5 | ... | 11-12-b13-b14 | 12-b13-b14-15

DOWN:  15-b14-b13-12 | b14-b13-12-11 | ... | 5-4-b3-2 | 4-b3-2-1
```

UP PATHS: EEEA | EEAA | EAAA | AAAD | AADD | ADDG | DDGG | DGGG | GGGB | GGBB | GBBB | BBBe

DOWN PATHS: eBBB | BBBG | BBGG | BGGG | GGGD | GGDD | GDDA | DDAA | DAAA | AAAE | AAEE | AEEE

Every group retains the same pick start; only the string-crossing location changes.

Mastery gate

Name every key; preserve all 24 groups; rebuild the upper frame cleanly; land every one-fret shift silently; and complete both pick starts on two separate days.

Level 26 - Natural Minor Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 01-02: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

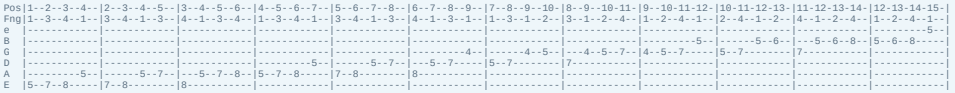
01 A NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E5 | FRAME 4-8

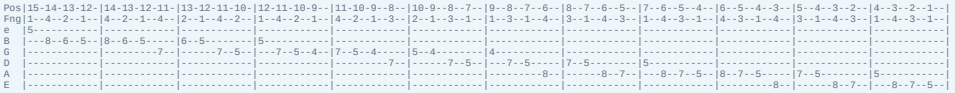
Scale tones: A B C D E F G A B C D E F G A

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

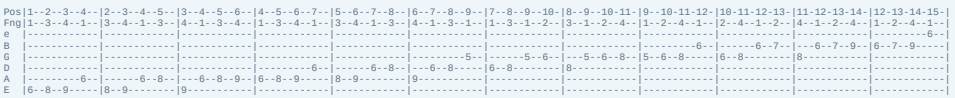
02 Bb NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E6 | FRAME 5-9

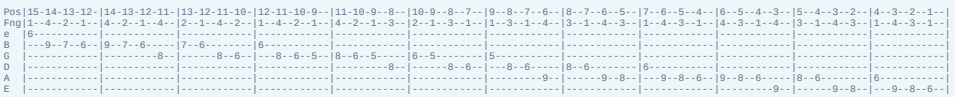
Scale tones: Bb C Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb C Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 26 - Natural Minor Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 03-04: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

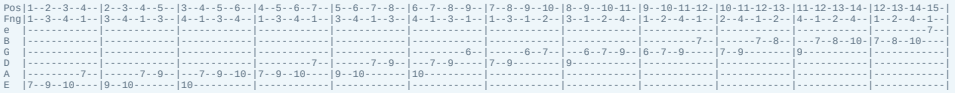
03 B NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E7 | FRAME 6-10

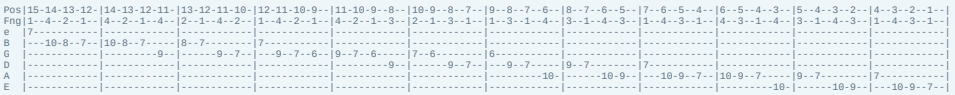
Scale tones: B C# D E F# G A B C# D E F# G A B

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

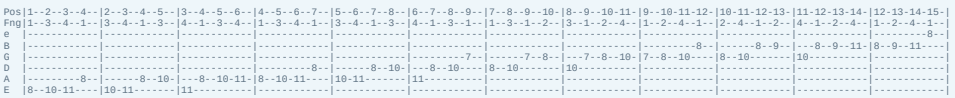
04 C NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E8 | FRAME 7-11

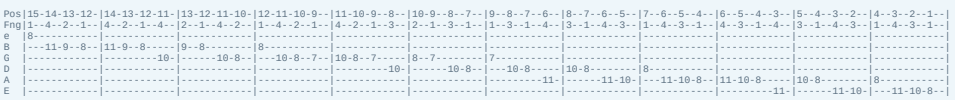
Scale tones: C D Eb F G Ab Bb C D Eb F G Ab Bb C

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 26 - Natural Minor Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 05-06: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

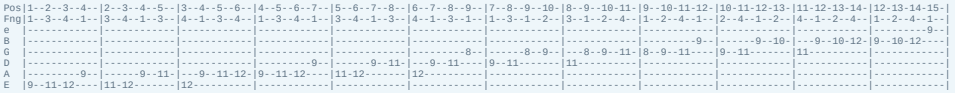
05 C# NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E9 | FRAME 8-12

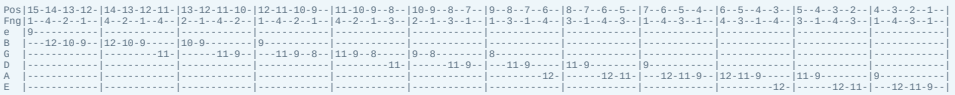
Scale tones: C# D# E F# G# A B C# D# E F# G# A B C#

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

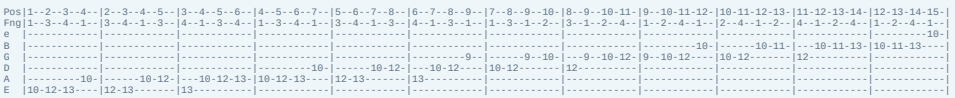
06 D NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E10 | FRAME 9-13

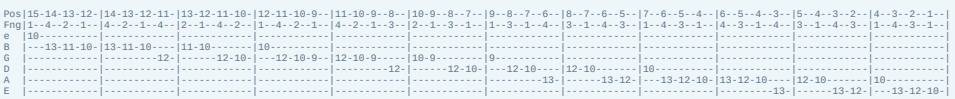
Scale tones: D E F G A Bb C D E F G A Bb C D

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 26 - Natural Minor Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 07-08: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

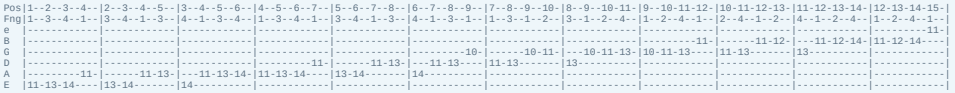
07 Eb NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E11 | FRAME 10-14

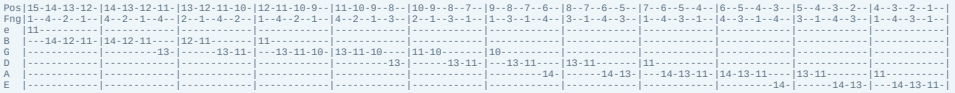
Scale tones: Eb F Gb Ab Bb Cb Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb Cb Db Eb

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

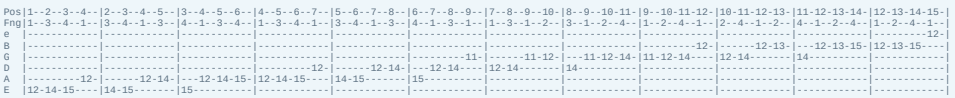
08 E NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E12 | FRAME 11-15

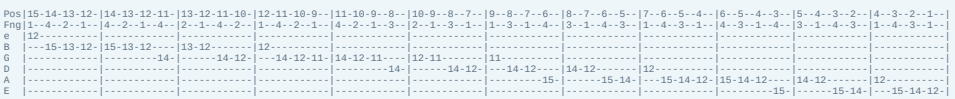
Scale tones: E F# G A B C D E F# G A B C D E

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 26 - Natural Minor Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 09-10: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

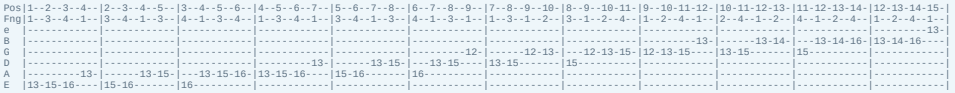
09 F NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E13 | FRAME 12-16

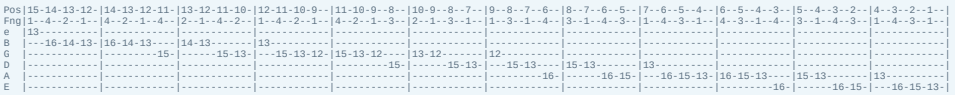
Scale tones: F G Ab Bb C Db Eb F G Ab Bb C Db Eb F

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

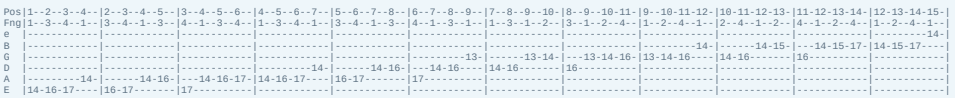
10 F# NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E14 | FRAME 13-17

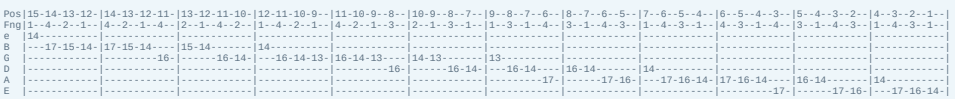
Scale tones: F# G# A B C# D E F# G# A B C# D E F#

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 26 - Natural Minor Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 11-12: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

11 G NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E15 | FRAME 14-18

Scale tones: G A Bb C D Eb F G A Bb C D Eb F G

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES

```
Pos|1--2--3--4--|2--3--4--5--|3--4--5--6--|4--5--6--7--|5--6--7--8--|6--7--8--9--|7--8--9--10-|8--9--10-11-|9--10-11-12-|10-11-12-13-|11-12-13-14-|12-13-14-15-|
Fng|1--3--4--1--|3--4--1--3--|4--1--3--4--|1--3--4--1--|3--4--1--3--|4--1--3--1--|1--3--1--2--|3--1--2--4--|1--2--4--1--|2--4--1--2--|4--1--2--4--|1--2--4--1--|
e  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------15-|
B  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------15-|------15-16-|---15-16-18-|15-16-18----|
G  |------------|------------|------------|---------15-|------15-17-|---15-17----|15-17-------|17----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
D  |------------|------------|---------15-|------15-17-|---15-17----|15-17-------|17----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
A  |---------15-|------15-17-|---15-17-18-|15-17-18----|17-18-------|18----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
E  |15-17-18----|17-18-------|18----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
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DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES

```
Pos|15-14-13-12-|14-13-12-11-|13-12-11-10-|12-11-10-9--|11-10-9--8--|10-9--8--7--|9--8--7--6--|8--7--6--5--|7--6--5--4--|6--5--4--3--|5--4--3--2--|4--3--2--1--|
Fng|1--4--2--1--|4--2--1--4--|2--1--4--2--|1--4--2--1--|4--2--1--3--|2--1--3--1--|1--3--1--4--|3--1--4--3--|1--4--3--1--|4--3--1--4--|3--1--4--3--|1--4--3--1--|
e  |15----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
B  |---18-16-15-|18-16-15----|16-15-------|15----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
G  |------------|---------17-|------17-15-|---17-15-14-|17-15-14----|15-14-------|14----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
D  |------------|------------|------------|---------17-|------17-15-|---17-15----|17-15-------|15----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
A  |------------|------------|------------|------------|---------18-|------18-17-|---18-17-15-|18-17-15----|17-15-------|15----------|------------|------------|
E  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------18-|------18-17-|---18-17-15-|------------|------------|
```

Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

12 G# NATURAL MINOR

ROOT E16 | FRAME 15-19

Scale tones: G# A# B C# D# E F# G# A# B C# D# E F# G#

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES

```
Pos|1--2--3--4--|2--3--4--5--|3--4--5--6--|4--5--6--7--|5--6--7--8--|6--7--8--9--|7--8--9--10-|8--9--10-11-|9--10-11-12-|10-11-12-13-|11-12-13-14-|12-13-14-15-|
Fng|1--3--4--1--|3--4--1--3--|4--1--3--4--|1--3--4--1--|3--4--1--3--|4--1--3--1--|1--3--1--2--|3--1--2--4--|1--2--4--1--|2--4--1--2--|4--1--2--4--|1--2--4--1--|
e  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------16-|
B  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------16-|------16-17-|---16-17-19-|16-17-19----|
G  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------15-|------15-16-|---15-16-18-|15-16-18----|16-18-------|18----------|------------|
D  |------------|------------|------------|---------16-|------16-18-|---16-18----|16-18-------|18----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
A  |---------16-|------16-18-|---16-18-19-|16-18-19----|18-19-------|19----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
E  |16-18-19----|18-19-------|19----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
```

DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES

```
Pos|15-14-13-12-|14-13-12-11-|13-12-11-10-|12-11-10-9--|11-10-9--8--|10-9--8--7--|9--8--7--6--|8--7--6--5--|7--6--5--4--|6--5--4--3--|5--4--3--2--|4--3--2--1--|
Fng|1--4--2--1--|4--2--1--4--|2--1--4--2--|1--4--2--1--|4--2--1--3--|2--1--3--1--|1--3--1--4--|3--1--4--3--|1--4--3--1--|4--3--1--4--|3--1--4--3--|1--4--3--1--|
e  |16----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
B  |---19-17-16-|19-17-16----|17-16-------|16----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
G  |------------|---------18-|------18-16-|---18-16-15-|18-16-15----|16-15-------|15----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
D  |------------|------------|------------|---------18-|------18-16-|---18-16----|18-16-------|16----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
A  |------------|------------|------------|------------|---------19-|------19-18-|---19-18-16-|19-18-16----|18-16-------|16----------|------------|------------|
E  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------19-|------19-18-|---19-18-16-|------------|------------|
```

Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 26 - Final Rung and Full Round-Trip Challenge

Rung 13: finish the fret-17 A-natural-minor cell, then reverse

Down pass: use rungs 12-01; do not replay rung 13

13 A NATURAL MINOR - OCTAVE

ROOT E17 | FRAME 16-20

Scale tones: A B C D E F G A B C D E F G A

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES

```
Pos|1--2--3--4--|2--3--4--5--|3--4--5--6--|4--5--6--7--|5--6--7--8--|6--7--8--9--|7--8--9--10-|8--9--10-11-|9--10-11-12-|10-11-12-13-|11-12-13-14-|12-13-14-15-|
Fng|1--3--4--1--|3--4--1--3--|4--1--3--4--|1--3--4--1--|3--4--1--3--|4--1--3--1--|1--3--1--2--|3--1--2--4--|1--2--4--1--|2--4--1--2--|4--1--2--4--|1--2--4--1--|
e  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------17-|
B  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------17-|------17-18--|---17-18-20-|17-18-20---|
G  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------16-|------16-17-|---16-17-19-|16-17-19----|17-19-------|19----------|------------|
D  |------------|------------|------------|---------17-|------17-19-|---17-19----|17-19-------|19----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
A  |---------17-|------17-19-|---17-19-20-|17-19-20----|19-20-------|20----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
E  |17-19-20----|19-20-------|20----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
```

DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES

```
Pos|15-14-13-12-|14-13-12-11-|13-12-11-10-|12-11-10-9--|11-10-9--8--|10-9--8--7--|9--8--7--6--|8--7--6--5--|7--6--5--4--|6--5--4--3--|5--4--3--2--|4--3--2--1--|
Fng|1--4--2--1--|4--2--1--4--|2--1--4--2--|1--4--2--1--|4--2--1--3--|2--1--3--1--|1--3--1--4--|3--1--4--3--|1--4--3--1--|4--3--1--4--|3--1--4--3--|1--4--3--1--|
e  |17----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
B  |---20-18-17-|20-18-17----|18-17-------|17----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
G  |------------|---------19-|------19-17-|---19-17-16-|19-17-16----|17-16-------|16----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
D  |------------|------------|------------|---------19-|------19-17-|---19-17----|19-17-------|17----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
A  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------20-|------20-19-|---20-19-17-|20-19-17----|19-17-------|17----------|------------|
E  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------20-|------20-19-|---20-19-17-|------------|
```

Return to the low root; release pressure; move the complete frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Full round-trip challenge

Start at A natural minor on low-E fret 5. Play rungs 01-13 without restarting the pick cycle. Reverse after the fret-17 cell and return through rungs 12-01. Say each key name aloud before its low root. Repeat the entire route with the opposite starting stroke.

ROUTE COUNT	25 cells x 96 notes = 2,400 picked notes.
TEMPO RULE	Add 2 BPM after 3 clean trips; reduce 4-6 BPM after 2 errors.
PICK STARTS	Complete one D-start round and one U-start round.

Clean-round standard

- No missing, added, or reordered four-note group.
- No pause or accent at a group boundary.
- Correct G-string backreach and B-string offset.
- Equal volume on both high-root notes at the turn.
- No scrape or tempo change during a one-fret shift.
- Sixteenth-note pulse stays even across all six strings.

The complete A-to-A-to-A route contains 25 cells and 2,400 continuously picked notes.

Level 26 - Practice Progression, Audits, and Mastery

Build range before speed: secure each half, link the turn, then add neighboring keys

Five-phase practice progression

1. **Ascending half**
   A minor only: 12 groups / 48 notes. One group per beat.
2. **Descending half**
   A minor only: 12 groups / 48 notes. Use both pick starts.
3. **Link the turn**
   Play all 96 notes. Keep the repeated high roots equal.
4. **Neighboring rungs**
   Use 2-3 keys and pause one beat only after the full cell.
5. **Full ladder**
   Remove the pause, reach fret 17, reverse, and return to fret 5.

Crossing and pulse audit

Group boundary	The rollback starts the next group; the beat must not hiccup.
D-to-G backreach	Release and rebuild; do not hold a five-fret static stretch.
G-to-B offset	Use the assigned B-string frame rather than copying the G string.
High-e endpoint	The lone high root belongs to the line; do not linger on it.
High-root turn	The two position-15 notes are equal and use opposite strokes.
Frame shift	Move only after note 96; release pressure before moving one fret.

After the basic ladder is clean

1. Accent note 1 of every group, then remove all accents.
2. Move the accent to notes 2, 3, and 4 on later passes.
3. Accent only positions 1, 3, 5, 7, 8, 10, 12, 14, and 15.
4. Play two groups per beat at half the metronome marking.
5. Begin at fret 17 and descend first.
6. Choose a random root fret 5-17, name the key, and continue.

These are Level 26 variations, not separate full levels.

Practice log and mastery gate

Date	BPM	D/U	Clean?	Weak point

MASTERY GATE BEFORE LEVEL 27

Complete the full route with a continuous sixteenth-note pulse, correct natural-minor geometry, silent one-fret shifts, and both pick starts on two separate days.

NEXT: Level 27 - Natural Minor Diatonic Thirds, Two Octaves.